

Anima Audiobook

Setup notes for selling the audiobook via Stripe, with automatic delivery to the buyer

The big picture

Selling a digital audiobook involves three distinct problems that have to be solved together: **encoding** (making the file small enough to deliver and store cheaply without hurting voice quality), **secure hosting** (the file cannot sit on the public site, or anyone who knows the URL gets it free), and **checkout + delivery** (Stripe takes the payment and the buyer receives a working download link). The setup below walks each in turn. The whole thing can be live, end-to-end, in an afternoon.

Step 1 — Compress the audiobook on your Mac

The source Anima.mp3 from ElevenLabs is 240 MB at 192 kbps mono. For voice content that bitrate is overkill — the Audible standard for spoken word is 64 kbps. The sweet spot is **96 kbps mono at 44.1 kHz**: indistinguishable from 192 kbps for narration, file size drops by roughly half. Run this once in Terminal on your Mac (it will take under a minute):

```
ffmpeg -i ~/Downloads/Anima.mp3 \
  -codec:a libmp3lame -b:a 96k -ac 1 -ar 44100 \
  -metadata title="Anima – The Field Trilogy, Book 1" \
  -metadata artist="José Gude MD" \
  -metadata album="The Field Trilogy" \
  -metadata genre="Audiobook" \
  ~/Downloads/anima-audiobook-en.mp3
```

Result: roughly **115 MB**, same 2:47:15 duration, voice quality preserved. Verify by opening the file in any audio player; if it sounds clean to you, it is ready to ship. If you want even smaller (Audible-equivalent), use -b:a 64k instead — the file drops to ~80 MB and is still acceptable for spoken word.

Step 2 — Host the file somewhere outside the public site

This is the part most first-time digital sellers get wrong. **Do not** simply upload the audiobook to josegudemd.com and link to it. Anyone who knows the URL gets it free, and search engines will index it. You need *access-controlled* hosting that gives out time-limited links only to confirmed buyers. The cleanest options:

Recommended: Cloudflare R2

Cloudflare's object storage service. Costs roughly \$0.015 per GB stored per month and *zero* for egress (data going out to buyers). A 115 MB audiobook costs about \$0.002/month to store no matter how many people download it. Pre-signed URLs are built in: you generate a URL valid for, say, 7 days, send it to the buyer, and it expires automatically. Sign up at cloudflare.com/r2, create a bucket, upload anima-audiobook-en.mp3.

Acceptable: AWS S3, Backblaze B2, or DigitalOcean Spaces

All work the same way: object storage with signed-URL generation. S3 is the most documented but has egress fees. Backblaze B2 is cheaper. DigitalOcean Spaces is the simplest control panel. Any of these works if you already have an account there.

Avoid: Google Drive, Dropbox, or simply uploading to your site

Google Drive and Dropbox links can be revoked but cannot be made time-limited per buyer; once someone has the share URL, they have it. Worse, both throttle bandwidth on viral links and your buyers may get errors. And as already noted, uploading to josegudem.com means the file is public.

Step 3 — Create the Stripe Payment Link

You already have Stripe Payment Links for the four signed books. The audiobook is a new product in the same Stripe account, with one important difference: it is a *digital good*, not a physical one. In the Stripe dashboard:

- (a) Products → Add product. Name: *Anima — Audiobook (MP3 download)*. Price: whatever you decide (\$15–25 is the typical range for an indie audiobook; the books are 2h45m of narration). Set the tax category to digital goods.
- (b) Payment links → Create. Select the product. Under *After payment* choose either *Show a confirmation page* (Stripe-hosted, simplest) or *Don't show confirmation, redirect to URL* (custom thank-you page on your site).
- (c) Under *Customer information*, require email — you need it for delivery.
- (d) Copy the resulting `buy.stripe.com/...` URL.

Step 4 — Connect payment to delivery (three options)

Option A — manual fulfillment (start here)

For the first 5–20 sales this is honestly fine. Stripe emails you a receipt every time someone buys; the buyer's email is on the receipt. Generate a fresh signed URL (Cloudflare R2 or whichever you chose) good for 7 days, paste it into a personal email to the buyer with a thank-you note, and send. Roughly 30 seconds of work per sale. The personal touch can actually be an asset for an indie author. Move to automation when the volume justifies it.

Option B — Stripe webhook + simple delivery script

When Stripe registers a successful checkout, it fires a webhook to a URL you provide. A small Cloudflare Worker script (or AWS Lambda, or a Vercel function) listens, verifies the webhook signature, generates a fresh signed R2 URL, and sends an email via a transactional email provider (Resend, Postmark, or SendGrid; all have free tiers). Cloudflare Worker code for the happy path is under 50 lines. A developer can wire this in two hours; Stripe's webhook documentation is excellent. This is the right setup if you cross ~50 sales per month.

Option C — off-the-shelf service that uses Stripe under the hood

Gumroad (gumroad.com), **Lemon Squeezy** (lemonsqueezy.com), **Payhip** (payhip.com), and **Podia** (podia.com) all give you a product page with payment + automatic file delivery in one click. They take

5–10% per sale (vs. Stripe's 2.9% + 30¢) but handle everything end-to-end, including VAT/sales-tax compliance, which matters more than people expect for EU sales. Lemon Squeezy is the best-engineered of the four; their merchant-of-record status means they handle VAT entirely. Trade-off: you do not own the customer relationship as cleanly as with direct Stripe.

Step 5 — Add the buy button to anima.html

Once you have the Stripe Payment Link URL, add an audiobook button to the existing buy row on anima.html. The HTML pattern matches what is already there:

```
<div class="buy-row">
  <a class="buy-btn solid" href="https://www.amazon.com/dp/B0H1WDCLQ1"
    target="_blank" rel="noopener">Amazon</a>
  <a class="buy-btn" href="https://buy.stripe.com/..."
    target="_blank" rel="noopener">Signed copy</a>
  <a class="buy-btn" href="https://buy.stripe.com/YOUR-AUDIOBOOK-LINK"
    target="_blank" rel="noopener">Audiobook (MP3)</a>
</div>
```

Mirror the same button (in Spanish: *Audiolibro (MP3)*) to es/anima.html. The existing CSS for .buy-btn handles styling automatically. If you decide to expand to the other books' audiobooks later, the pattern is identical — one Stripe Payment Link per book.

On piracy — what to worry about, what not to

Time-limited signed URLs solve the easy case: random scrapers and search engines never see the file. They do *not* stop a paying customer from re-uploading the MP3 to a torrent. No technology stops that for unencrypted audio. The honest reality is that all indie audiobooks leak eventually, and the only durable defenses are: **(1)** price competitively so the incentive to pirate is small; **(2)** make the buying experience genuinely better than the torrent experience (instant delivery, personal email, signed PDFs of liner notes as a bonus); **(3)** rely on the fact that your readers are unusually principled people for whom paying the author matters. Audible spends millions on DRM and it gets cracked anyway. For a thoughtful indie audiobook with a literate audience, the social contract works better than any technical control.

On the bookshop button placeholders

The unwired *Bookshop* buttons that previously sat on every book page have been removed from anima.html, numen.html, limen.html, fragile-light.html and all four Spanish mirrors. The sitemap.html and tour.html descriptive text has been updated accordingly. If you later get a Bookshop.org affiliate URL working, the same pattern can be slotted back into the buy-row.

Setup notes prepared 10 June 2026. The fastest path to live: do Step 1 on your Mac tonight, create a Cloudflare R2 bucket and upload tomorrow, set up the Stripe Payment Link the same day, and run Option A (manual delivery) until the volume tells you to automate. Total time to first sale: under a day if everything goes smoothly.